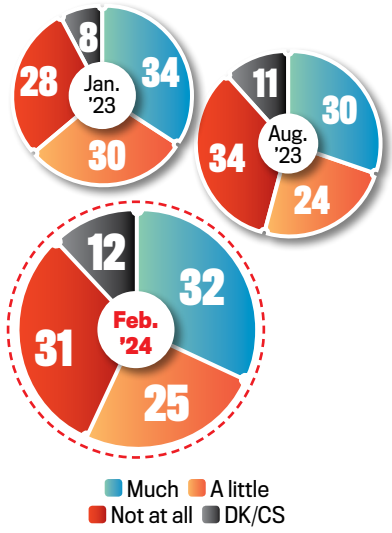
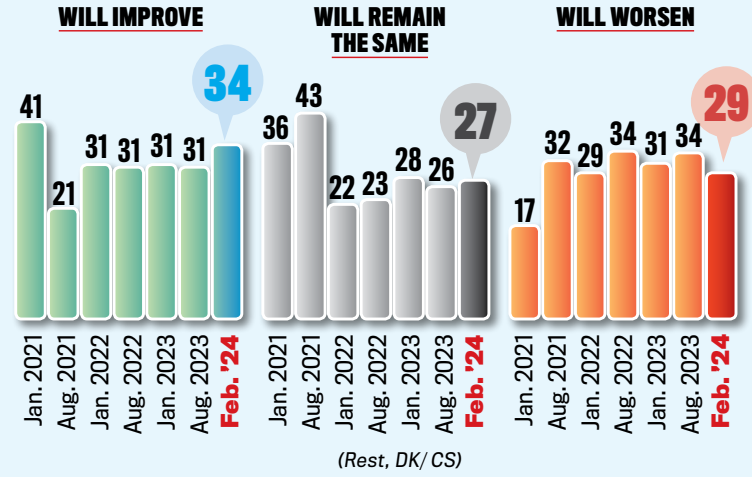
Q. Has the Modi government been able to generate employment?



A marginal rise in those who believe that the govt has created enough jobs

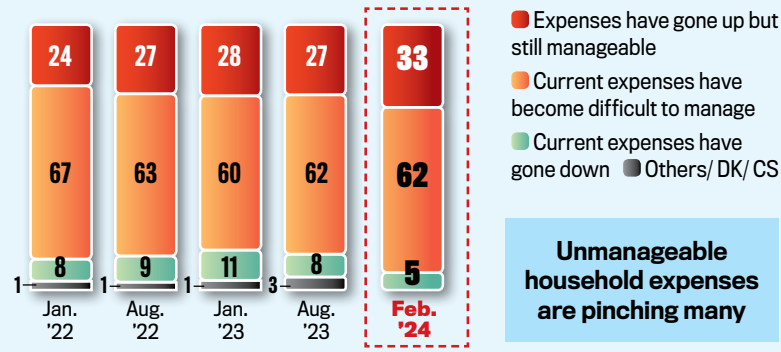
Q. How do you perceive the state of the Indian economy to be in the next six months?



(Rest, DK/ CS)

Many are optimistic that the economy will improve

Q. How would you compare your current daily expenses with those last year?



Unmanageable household expenses are pinching many

All figures in % and rounded off

Experts argue that the quality of jobs has deteriorated over time. There is an increase in the number of self-employed workers

their status had improved were 43 per cent, a figure that reached 49 per cent in January 2020. It fell in August 2021 as the Centre fought the second and most debilitating wave of Covid. One saving grace for the government is that the perception that things have improved is slightly higher this time compared to the August 2023 MOTN when it was 29.5 per cent. Many (34 per cent) are also optimistic that the economy will improve in the next six months, even as 29 per cent feel it will deteriorate during that period. There is no doubt that the shadow of the Ukraine war and the war in Gaza weigh heavily on the global economy, and any escalation is likely to have a far-reaching impact on trade and investment.

The pessimism holds for incomes too. A considerable 36.4 per cent of the respondents believe that their household income is not likely to increase over time, and an additional 29.5 per cent fear it will worsen, indicating that India's growth story may not translate into an improved standard of living for many. Households seem to be feeling the pinch of stagnating incomes and rising living costs. A substantial 61.7 per cent of the respondents state that their current expenses have become difficult to manage. Though the RBI has managed to keep inflation in check, it is still skimming the upper target limit of 6 per cent (retail inflation was 5.69 per cent in December last year). There are 33.2 per cent of the respondents who agree that their expenses have gone up, but say they can manage them. Not surprisingly, there is subdued demand for consumer products such as durables and even essential items like food and groceries, which are experiencing low growth or